

WHITE TEA

Considered the most nuanced and subtle of teas, white tea contains a number of healthy compounds including polyphenols. It is an early tea, picked just as the first buds appear, and therefore given high status in the Chinese tea world. It can be a challenge to appreciate this subtler tea with layered flavors, especially for those who prefer rich black teas.

There is only a handful of styles of white tea: Bai Hao Yin Zhen (Silver Needles) is the highest quality, and is divided into even more refined groups, with pricing reflecting the quality. Bai Mu Dan (White Peony), a more affordable style, contains silver buds as well as large leaves.

PREPARATION GUIDELINES

Tea shown here: Bai Mu Dan (White Peony), from Fuding, Fujian province, China

Measure: 2 tbsp for $\frac{3}{4}$ cup water

Water temperature: 185°F (85°C).
Use spring water, if possible.

Infusion: Steep for 2 minutes, and increase steep time by 30 seconds for each infusion.
Can be used for 2–3 infusions.



DRY LEAVES

White tea leaves have silver buds with larger, brittle, dark green or brown leaves.



WET LEAVES

When infused, the tea displays velvety buds, large, green, multi-shaded leaves, and twigs.



LIQUOR

Light golden in color, the infusion has a sweet aroma, with flavors of pine, corn, and burnt sugar.